

Healthcare Outcomes, 2025 (Expanded)

What Actually Happened · Answer key, not a signal bank

RESEARCH UPDATE, 2025

The World Obesity Atlas 2025 confirms global adult obesity has more than doubled since 1990, with over a billion people worldwide now living with obesity.

HEADLINE, March 2020

Canada's national public health agency becomes the backbone of the country's COVID-19 response, coordinating efforts at a scale the system was never built for before.

SURVEY RESULT, 2025

Despite less stigma than a generation ago, rates of teen anxiety and depression have risen sharply over the past two decades, prompting officials in multiple countries to describe a youth mental health crisis.

STAT CARD, 2025

GLP-1 weight-loss drugs are now an \$80 billion a year global market. Roughly 10 million Americans alone are currently taking one.

AWARD ANNOUNCEMENT, October 2023

Katalin Karikó, once unable to get her mRNA research funded, shares the Nobel Prize in Medicine after the technology was used to build COVID-19 vaccines in under a year.

POLICY BRIEF, 2023

As part of a new national health funding deal, Ottawa earmarks dedicated money for mental health and substance use services as one of its named priorities, building on smaller bilateral agreements that began in 2017.

QUOTE, 2025

"We're competing with GLP-1 demand for surgical resources now," says a Canadian bariatric surgeon, on why wait times for surgery are still climbing even as a non-surgical option exists.

PUBLIC HEALTH ALERT, November 10, 2025

Canada officially loses its measles elimination status after sustained transmission for over a year and more than 2,300 cases.

PRODUCT NOTICE, April 2018

The UK's new tax on sugary drinks takes effect, part of a wave of similar measures other countries are now considering to curb rising obesity rates.

POLL RESULT, 2025

Public trust in the CDC's vaccine guidance has fallen to under half of Americans, down from roughly 85% in 2020.

INTERVIEW EXCERPT, 2025

"I go to therapy every week and I tell people that," says a public figure, the kind of statement that would have been almost unthinkable from someone in the spotlight a generation ago.

MAGAZINE EXCERPT, 2025

An old low-carb diet craze that once dominated bestseller lists is barely remembered today, replaced almost entirely by drug-based solutions.

STATUS REPORT, 2025

A WHO-coordinated international network for tracking disease outbreaks remains active, having been used repeatedly during COVID-19 and more recent outbreaks, linking labs and health agencies across dozens of countries.

WORKPLACE MEMO, 2025

A growing number of countries, including France, Ireland, and parts of Canada, have passed right-to-disconnect laws, two decades after employers first flagged stress and burnout as a leading cause of leave.

HEADLINE, 2024

UK Childhood Obesity Rates Never Reversed, two decades after officials first sounded the alarm.

FUNDING NOTICE, 2025

Antiretroviral treatment for HIV now reaches tens of millions of people worldwide, and AIDS-related deaths have fallen sharply over the past two decades.

OP-ED, 2025

A public health funding analyst writes that money flows after a crisis proves the need, then dries up again, pointing to pandemic-preparedness budgets shrinking just a few years after COVID.

LETTER TO THE EDITOR, 2025

Mental health coverage under most employer and provincial plans is still thinner than coverage for physical illness, a reader writes, even as demand for therapy keeps growing.

CONFERENCE NOTE, 2021

England's flagship anti-stigma mental health campaign shuts down after government funding is withdrawn, even as public attitude surveys show the stigma reduction work succeeded faster than expected.

POLICY BRIEF, 2020

Obesity Canada redefines obesity as a chronic disease in its national guidelines. Only Alberta's provincial government will go on to formally recognize it as one, leaving most Canadians without drug coverage.

WIRE STORY, March 11, 2020

The World Health Organization formally declares COVID-19 a global pandemic, the moment the public health systems built up in the years before are put to their biggest test yet.

TREATMENT UPDATE, 2020

Hydroxychloroquine is heavily promoted early in the pandemic as a possible COVID-19 treatment. Larger clinical trials later find no meaningful benefit, and the early hype quietly fades.

FACT CHECK, 2021

Ivermectin gains a large online following as an unproven COVID-19 treatment. Major health agencies continue to find no solid evidence it works, and the trend fades as more data comes in.